

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 42140.43 ▼ 269.67 0.64% NASDAQ 19010.08 ▲ 1.6% STOXX 600 545.17 ▲ 0.1% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 11/32, yield 4.498% OIL \$63.67 ▲ \$1.72 GOLD \$3,240.30 ▲ \$20.30 EURO \$1.1187 YEN 147.48

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Inflation was relatively mild** in April, with the CPI rising a seasonally adjusted 0.2%, but economists said tariffs will end a recent lull and push up more prices in the coming months. **A1**

◆ **The mild inflation** reading helped the S&P 500 return to the black for 2025 with a 0.7% gain, while the Nasdaq rose 1.6% and the Dow industrials fell 0.6%. **B12**

◆ **Honda and Nissan** warned that earnings will be hit hard by U.S. tariffs, underlining the risk of an industrywide downturn in the Japanese auto sector. **B1**

◆ **UnitedHealth Group** said Chief Executive Andrew Witty stepped down for personal reasons after presiding over a punishing period for the company, including a steep drop in its shares. **A1, A6**

◆ **Microsoft is laying off** thousands of employees across various divisions around the world in an effort to shed layers of management. **B1**

◆ **ESPN's highly anticipated** streaming service set to be launched in the fall will cost \$29.99 a month and carry the ESPN name. **B1**

◆ **Apple is embracing** brain-computer interfaces, unveiling a technology that one day could revolutionize how humans interact with devices. **B1**

◆ **China reopened itself** to Boeing, the biggest U.S. exporter, after the two nations reached a temporary truce in their trade war. **B3**

◆ **A Giacometti bust** that had a \$70 million asking price failed to sell at Sotheby's, putting a damper on this week's art auctions in New York. **B2**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump said the U.S.** will lift sanctions on Syria following the ouster of its decadeslong dictator last year, and issued a pointed warning to Iran while pushing for a new nuclear deal. **A1**

◆ **Republican lawmakers** expressed national security concerns over the proposed \$400 million plane Qatar wants to give the U.S. for use as Air Force One. **A6**

◆ **The Menendez brothers** were resentenced to 50 years to life in prison for the 1989 shotgun murders of their parents, making them eligible for parole. **A3**

◆ **The prosecution's** star witness in the sex-trafficking case against Sean "Diddy" Combs told jurors she took part in drug-fueled parties as her relationship with the defendant turned abusive. **A3**

◆ **The Trump administration** cut another \$450 million in grants to Harvard in its escalating pressure campaign against the university. **A2**

◆ **Israeli forces targeted** Hamas's top leader in Gaza in an airstrike which, if successful, would mark an important military victory. **A7**

◆ **Companies could lose** valuable carbon credits after a court intervened in a dispute between conservationists and the Maasai herders in Kenya they were claiming to help. **A8**

◆ **British counterterrorism** police are investigating suspected arson attacks on two properties linked to Prime Minister Keir Starmer. **A9**

◆ **Died: José "Pepe" Mujica**, 89, insurgent who became president of Uruguay. **A8**

CONTENTS	Markets Digest..... B9
Arts in Review..... A15	Opinion..... A17-19
Business News..... B3-5	Personal Journal A12-13
Capital Account..... A4	Property Report..... B6
Crossword..... A16	Sports..... A16
Heard on Street..... B12	U.S. News..... A2-6
Markets..... B11-12	World News..... A7-8



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President Trump and Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman met at the Royal Palace in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, on Tuesday.

Trump to Lift Syria Sanctions, Warns Iran on Nuclear Deal

RIYADH, Saudi Arabia—President Trump said Tuesday that the U.S. will lift sanctions on Syria following the ouster of its decadeslong dictator last

By Stephen Kalin,
Alexander Ward
and Alex Leary

year, and he issued a pointed warning to Iran while pushing for a new nuclear deal.

Trump, kicking off the first major overseas trip of his second term with a glitzy visit to the desert kingdom, said it was time to give Syria a finan-

cial lifeline after rebels overthrew the regime of Bashar al-Assad in December.

"I will be ordering cessation of sanctions against Syria," Trump said during an address in Riyadh, his first stop on a four-day swing through the Gulf. "Now it's their time to shine. We're taking them all off."

The announcement sets the table for Trump to speak with new Syrian President Ahmed al-Sharaa on Wednesday in the Saudi capital.

On the first day of the visit, Trump also issued an ultima-

tum to Iran as he aims to prevent the country from obtaining a nuclear weapon.

"One way or another, make your move," he said, adding the country would face "massive maximum pressure" if it doesn't curb its nuclear work soon. "The offer will not last forever."

Trump also sealed \$300 billion in deals with the Saudis, with an eye toward doubling that total within four years. Heaping praise on the kingdom's crown prince, Mohammed bin Salman, he encouraged Riyadh to move toward normal-

izing relations with Israel, despite the continuing war in Gaza that left Palestinians no closer to self-rule, a longstanding Saudi precondition.

His overarching message was that the U.S. will remain engaged and close to the region as long as its money pours into the U.S. economy.

"You achieved a modern miracle, the Arabian way," Trump said of the Gulf's oil-rich monarchies. "The Gulf na-

Please turn to page A7

◆ **Republicans raise doubts** on Trump plane gift..... A6

Investors Who Held Steady Reap Rewards

By IMANI MOISE
AND HANNAH ERIN LANG

When the trade war tanked the market last month and left even seasoned Wall Street pros scrambling, Andrew Skillman kept his cool.

Skillman, a Santa Fe, N.M., resident whose portfolio is split between stocks and bonds, stood pat throughout the market gyrations of early 2025. "I never panicked," the 60-year-old investor said. "Timing the market is fruitless. No one has a crystal ball."

He and other investors with an equally steely resolve are being rewarded in a big way. President Trump's easing of his harsh tariff policies has stoked a

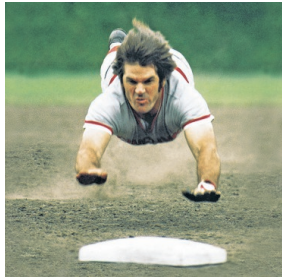
comeback in stocks, with major indexes recovering their losses since he rolled out his plans on April 2. The S&P 500 returned to positive territory for the year on Tuesday, rising 0.7% to its highest close since Feb. 28 and extending gains that began Monday after the U.S. and China agreed to suspend most tariffs. Asian markets were mixed early Wednesday and U.S. stock futures were mostly unchanged.

To get to this point, investors such as Skillman had to absorb—or ignore—a lot of bad news. The Nasdaq Composite Index at one point entered bear-

Please turn to page A6

◆ **S&P 500 turns positive** for 2025..... B12

INSIDE



SPORTS ILLUSTRATED/GETTY IMAGES

SPORTS

Pete Rose and 'Shoeless' Joe Jackson removed from MLB's banned list. **A16**

PERSONAL JOURNAL

Six longtime friends tried to plan a girls' trip in a group chat. Things went sideways. **A12**

UnitedHealth CEO Exits, Stock Drops

By ANNA WILDE MATHEWS
AND CHRISTOPHER WEAVER

UnitedHealth Group said Chief Executive Andrew Witty stepped down after presiding over a punishing period for the company, including a steep drop in its shares after its quarterly earnings last month fell significantly short of investors' expectations.

Chairman Stephen Hemsley will return immediately to running the healthcare giant he helped build.

The April earnings miss pushed UnitedHealth shares down by more than a third, resulting in the loss of about \$190 billion in market capitalization. The shares fell an ad-

ditional 18% on Tuesday, when the company also said it was suspending the reduced 2025 earnings outlook that it issued last month.

Witty, who the company said stepped down for "personal reasons," became CEO of UnitedHealth in 2021 after earlier running pharmaceutical company GlaxoSmithKline. He was at the helm during a time of tumult: UnitedHealth saw a hack of its technology unit bring much of the U.S. healthcare economy to a standstill; the fatal shooting of a top executive shook employ-

Please turn to page A6

◆ **UnitedHealth's returning** CEO faces challenges..... A6

First Rule Of This Club: Talk Endlessly

* * *
AMC A-List
members never
stop yapping

By ANN-MARIE ALCÁNTARA

The AMC A-List is not an exclusive club. Membership costs \$20 to \$28 a month and anyone older than 13 can join.

But its nearly one million members brag about the movie subscription service as if they're part of United Airlines' invitation-only Global Service status. They post about it on social media, treat it like a core personality trait and try to enlist their friends and family members to join—over and over again.

Savannah Oviedo admits she's no exception. "I unfortunately fit the exact archetype of the A-lister," Please turn to page A13

Many Afrikaners Don't Want to Leave

Trump offered them refugee status, but South Africa group has wealth, history

By ALEXANDRA WEXLER

SETTLERS, South Africa—Afrikaners, white South Africans long reviled as the architects of a racist state, are now being recast by Donald Trump as the victims of one.

The U.S. president has accused South Africa's Black-majority government of plotting to seize white farms and failing to stop "violent attacks on innocent disfavored minority farmers." His top adviser, white South Africa-born billionaire Elon Musk, has accused some of the country's politicians of actively promoting a "white genocide."

Trump, who has centered his presidency on a promise to evict millions of migrants from the U.S., is clearing away obstacles so that Afrikaners

who want to emigrate enjoy a smooth path to American citizenship.

On Monday, several dozen Afrikaners arrived in the U.S. on a chartered flight that landed outside Washington, the first group granted refugee status under Trump's executive order. The white South Africans were welcomed by Deputy Secretary of Homeland Security Troy Edgar and Deputy Secretary of State Christopher Landau, who said the people told him of "harrowing stories of the violence they faced in South Africa."

In response to a reporter's question, Landau said the president paused the broader refugee program for other groups of people because it wasn't clear they had been Please turn to page A9



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